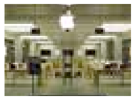
Android 2.0 for Moto360
Sticking to their promise, motorola has finally started rolling Android Wear 2.0 updates for the moto 360 watch. **http://dgit.in/2moto360**



Apple's dedicated AI chip
Apple is working on a processor (internally known as Apple Neutral Engine) devoted specifically to AI-related tasks. **http://dgit.in/AIchip**

AGENT001

Hold that upgrade!

Both AMD and Intel have a few tricks up their sleeves in the near future.

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Of late, I've seen a lot of folks wondering if they should move to AMD since there's a lot more cores and threads on offer for a much lower price. And then there has been a slew of announcements around not only CPUs but also GPUs primarily thanks to AMD because they've finally got great CPUs and GPUs out. Both Intel and NVIDIA have started proactively making changes to their product lines and schedules to combat the red thread. NVIDIA recently released the GT 1030 and that too without any fanfare to combat the RX 550 that AMD released. Intel dropped prices across the board when the Ryzen 7 was announced and did so again when Ryzen 5 was announced. Not only that, but there's also a Hyper-Threaded Core i5 processor that's supposed to come out soon. Traditionally, Hyper-Threading wasn't seen in Core i5 SKUs but that's set to change as the Ryzen 5 1400 and 1500X both pack 4 cores and 8 threads thanks to SMT (generic term for having multiple threads for one physical core). However, these aren't the exciting announcements.

Unless you've been living under a rock, you should have heard about ThreadRipper and Basin Falls. The former is an upcoming CPU from AMD with 16 cores and 32 threads while the latter is the upcoming Intel Extreme processor platform which has a 12 core / 24 threaded CPU at the top. Both AMD and Intel seem to be heating up the CPU race and I couldn't be any more happier. It's going to drop prices for CPUs which have been quite expensive of late. I'm not going to mention what my current configuration is for the sake of avoiding embarrassment. It's high time I upgraded and even I'm willing to wait for a couple of month more just so that I can see this battle play out.

Intel's Basin Falls platform is rumoured to be released under the Core i9 brand and the flagship 12 core / 24 thread CPU is probably going to be the Core i9-7920X with 44 PCIe lanes emanating from the CPU and a TDP of 160W. Holy Cow! (No offense to any right-wingers) That's a lot. Then there's the 7900X, 7820X and the 7800X. All of these are going to need motherboards featuring the upcoming X299 chipset.

On the other hand, AMD has the Ryzen 9 1998X which is the 16 core / 32 thread behemoth. It seems as if AMD went all Super Saiyan on the Ryzen 7 1800X to birth the Ryzen 9 1998X. Of course, even AMD will have multiple SKUs in the Ryzen 9 sub-brand. And by the looks of all the leaks that have surfaced over the last couple of weeks, it appears that AMD will have more SKUs at launch. Nine SKUs to be precise. And here's the good part, every single one of them will support 44 PCIe lanes. With Intel, only the 7920X and 7900X had 44 PCIe lanes. The next two CPUs will only have 28 lanes so that's a massive loss for the consumer. You see, of late, a lot of motherboards have begun including multiple NVMe slots for SSDs. NVMe uses PCIe. So the fewer PCIe lanes there are, the fewer features can be included on a motherboard. Of course, there are methods like adding multiplexers to increase more PCIe lanes but that's an additional cost which trickles down to the consumer at the end of the day.

While it may seem that AMD is offering more, you need to take a closer look at Intel. The core clocks on the Intel CPUs are higher with the Turbo clocks taking it much further ahead. AMD on the other hand has had trouble with hitting the high clocks. Moreover, single-threaded performance and gaming haven't exactly panned out in AMD's favour. So now it seems Intel has a significant advantage thanks to its legacy optimisation.

The trouble is that neither AMD, nor Intel have released CPUs with such a large number of cores packed into a single die. Server processors are a different story and are clocked way lower than desktop variants. So there are challenges for both brands that need to play out. Which is why I shall wait till both are out and I can test them personally to figure which one I should get. I suggest you do the same.